

RESOURCE 04 · COLD OUTREACH

Outreach Without Sounding Like a Template

A cold message that gets a reply is four sentences, not four paragraphs.

To: priya@example.com
Subject: Question on Kafka consumer-group rebalancing

1

SPECIFIC REASON YOU REACHED OUT

"Hi Priya, I read your post on consumer-group rebalancing last week. The point on partition skew under cooperative-sticky lined up with a problem I've been chewing on."

2

WHO YOU ARE (ONE SENTENCE)

"I'm a senior backend engineer, mostly working in payments."

3

SPECIFIC, EASY ASK

"Would you have 15 minutes sometime in the next two weeks to talk about how your team picked the assignment strategy?"

4

LOWER THE COST OF YES

"Happy to keep it async over message if that's easier."

Thanks,
[Your name]

Reply rate by message type

Template
Without context



~60%

25-40%

With context